

THE 1950s

The jet age came into its own with the setting of new speed records and the first jet airliner. Radar and new air traffic control systems steadily improved safety.

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THE 1960s

The Cold War years gave rise to ever-faster jets, sleek spy planes, and sophisticated helicopters. Airliners such as the Boeing 707 came into use on the long-haul routes.

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THE 1970s

The Boeing 747 revolutionized commercial air transport. Fighter planes were routinely flying faster than the speed of sound, and Concorde brought the same performance to the civilian market. Vertical takeoff allowed powerful combat jets to be launched from oceangoing carriers.

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